

USER MANUAL

A practical guide to browsing neighbourhood posts, creating an account, sharing updates, commenting and managing your account.

ABOUT THE SCREEN IMAGES

The images in this guide are existing design previews from the project, not screenshots captured from the running application. They are included only as visual references; the instructions describe the current screens and behavior.

The notice board

The board is the main place to read community notices. You can browse public posts without signing in. Sign in to access member-only posts and interactive features.

The screenshot displays the 'Neighbourhood Board' website for 'Elm Vale & surrounds'. The header includes a navigation bar with categories: All, Events, Services, For Sale, Give Away, Lost & Found, and Announcements. A search bar and a dropdown menu for filters (set to 'Any') are located below the navigation bar. The main content area features five notice cards, each with a title, category label, author, date, location, and comment count. The notices are: 1. 'Riverside Park Community Picnic — All Welcome' (EVENTS) by Priya Okafor, 29 Sept 2026, Riverside / Central, 2 comments. 2. 'Vintage Oak Dining Table — Seats 8' (FOR SALE) by Sarah M., 28 Sept 2026, Northfield, 3 comments. 3. 'Experienced Childminder — Ofsted Registered' (SERVICES) by Mei Callahan, 28 Sept 2026, Elmwood, 1 comment. 4. 'Free: Large Collection of Children's Books (Ages 3–9)' (GIVE AWAY) by Tom Hendricks, 27 Sept 2026, Westbrook. 5. 'FOUND: Small Tortoiseshell Cat — Wearing Pink Collar' (LOST & FOUND) by Dan Ujewellyn, 29 Sept 2026, Eastgate, 1 comment.

Neighbourhood Board Elm Vale & surrounds Log in Register

All Events Services For Sale Give Away Lost & Found Announcements

Search posts... Any

Riverside Park Community Picnic — All Welcome
EVENTS by Priya Okafor · 29 Sept 2026 · 08:42 · Riverside / Central · 2 comments

Join us this Saturday for our annual summer picnic at Riverside Park! We'll have tables set up near the bandstand from 11am. Bring your own food and a blanket. There'll be lawn games, face painting for kids, and a raffle with some great local prizes donated by businesses on the high street.

Everyone is welcome — dogs on leads are fine too. In case of heavy rain we'll move to the pavilion. Look for the green gazebo near the main entrance.

Vintage Oak Dining Table — Seats 8
FOR SALE by Sarah M. · 28 Sept 2026 · 17:05 · Northfield · 3 comments

Solid oak dining table in excellent condition, circa 1970s. Seats 8 comfortably, 10 at a push. Some minor surface marks consistent with age, otherwise very solid and sturdy. Comes with 6 matching chairs (two have been reupholstered in navy linen).

Asking £280 for the set. Collection only — based in Northfield. Can help carry to a van if needed. No time wasters please, price is firm.

Experienced Childminder — Ofsted Registered
SERVICES by Mei Callahan · 28 Sept 2026 · 11:20 · Elmwood · 1 comment

Friendly, experienced childminder with 12 years' experience. Ofsted registered with outstanding rating. Available Monday to Friday, 7:30am–6pm. Term-time and full year places available for children aged 3 months to 8 years.

I have a large safe garden and take children on outings to local parks, libraries and soft play. Full meals and snacks included. References available. Based in Elmwood — happy to chat for an informal look around before you commit to anything.

Free: Large Collection of Children's Books (Ages 3–9)
GIVE AWAY by Tom Hendricks · 27 Sept 2026 · 14:30 · Westbrook

Having a clear-out as our kids have grown up. Roughly 60–70 books in good to very good condition — picture books, early readers, some Roald Dahl, Horrid Henry, Rainbow Magic series, and more. Would prefer them to go as a bundle rather than individually.

Free to a good home. Collection from Sycamore Avenue, Westbrook — anytime this week from 5pm or Saturday morning. First to message and confirm gets them.

FOUND: Small Tortoiseshell Cat — Wearing Pink Collar
LOST & FOUND by Dan Ujewellyn · 29 Sept 2026 · 06:58 · Eastgate · 1 comment

Found this friendly girl wandering on Birch Lane last night (Saturday). She has a pink collar but no tag. Very well-fed and affectionate so clearly someone's pet. She's now safe indoors with us.

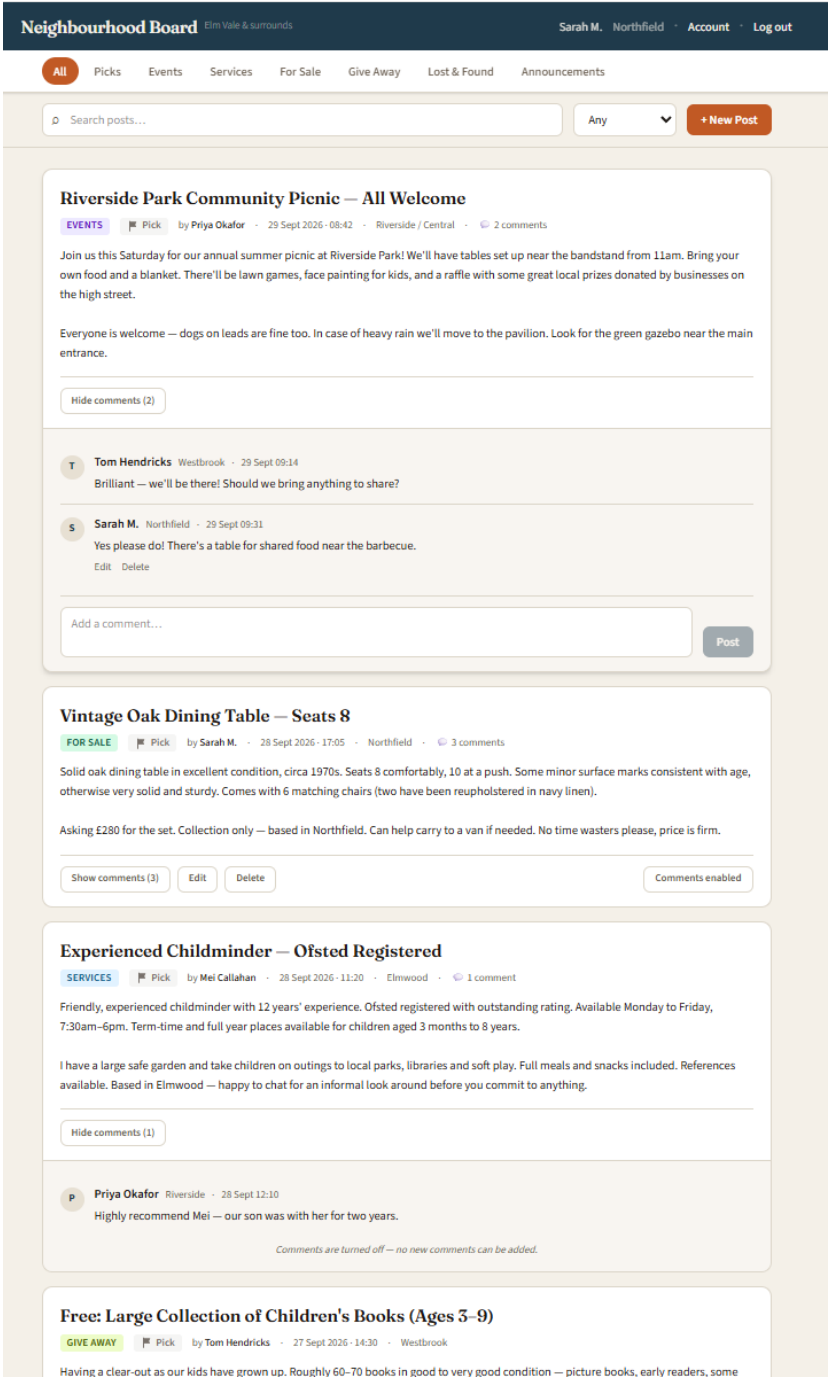
If she's yours or you know whose she is, please get in touch. Happy to send photos. Based in the Birch Lane / Poplar Street area of Eastgate.

ILLUSTRATIVE DESIGN PREVIEW

This image is supplied in the project design folder. Its category labels, layout and sample content may not match the current application.

Browsing while signed in

After signing in, the board provides additional member tools. The exact arrangement in the live page may differ from this older design preview.

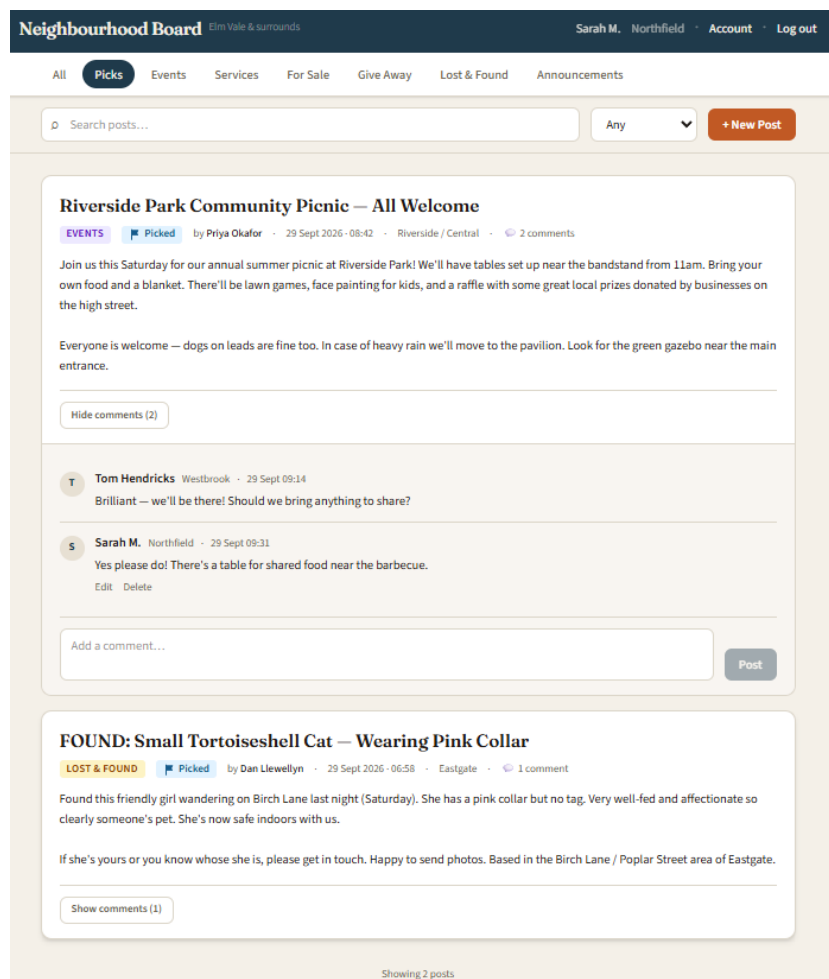


ILLUSTRATIVE DESIGN PREVIEW

The preview shows example posts, comments and member controls. It is not a live capture and may not reflect current styling.

Member picks: visual reference

Signed-in members can mark a post as picked and use the Picks filter to view posts they have picked. The project also contains this reference preview of a picked-post view.



ILLUSTRATIVE DESIGN PREVIEW

Use the current board navigation and pick controls; this preview is not a screenshot of the running version.

Browse, search and filter

Browse categories

- Choose All to see the available feed, or select Events, Services, Lost and Found, Free to Good Home, Selling or Announcements to narrow by category.
- Public visitors see posts marked Public. Sign in to see posts marked Members only.

Search the feed

Type one or more words in the search box and choose Search. Each word must match either the post title or its body; words are combined as AND conditions. Search looks through posts, not comments.

Filter by date

- Choose All, Last 24hr, Last 7 Days or Last Week. Recent comments can also make a post appear in a recent-activity date filter.

Distance (signed-in members)

When signed in, choose Any or a distance of 5, 10, 20 or 50 km. Distance is based on the location saved in your account and the location on each post. Visitors who are not signed in do not get this filter.

TIP

Changing the search or filters refreshes the list. Use All and Any to broaden the results again.

Create an account, sign in and recover access

Create an account

- Choose Register from the board and enter a username (3-25 characters). The live username check reports whether the name is available; the server also checks when you submit.
- Enter and confirm a password (8-25 characters). The form shows password-strength guidance and indicators for length, uppercase letters, numbers and symbols.
- Enter a security question and answer (each 1-25 characters), then choose your default location and submit Register.
- If a username is already used or disallowed, or another required value is invalid, correct the displayed error and try again. Registration returns you to Login when successful.

Sign in

Select Login, enter your username and password, then submit. Login failures can trigger a temporary wait; the form tells you when another attempt is allowed. Repeated failures can suspend an account.

Forgot your password?

- Choose Forgot your password? on the Login screen and enter your username.
- Answer the security question saved on your account. Incorrect attempts may be temporarily rate-limited.
- Choose a new password and confirm it. Recovery requires 8-25 characters, at least one uppercase letter, one number and one symbol, plus a minimum strength score. Follow the on-screen guidance.
- Use Cancel to leave recovery. Password recovery is by username and security answer; no email reset is offered in this workflow.

Create and manage posts

Create a post

- Sign in, then choose Post in the top bar.
- Enter a title (6-50 characters) and body (1-1000 characters). The body accepts plain text; supported http:// and https:// URLs are displayed as links that open in a new browser tab.
- Select a category, the post location, and visibility: Public or Members only.
- Choose whether comments are enabled. When creating a post, select an expiry of 7, 14 or 30 days.
- Choose Save. To leave without saving, choose Cancel.

Edit or delete your post

Use Edit on one of your own posts to update its title, body, category, location, visibility or comments setting. The expiry is shown but is not editable on the edit form. Use Delete to remove a post; deletion cannot be undone.

PLAIN TEXT ONLY

Do not paste HTML or formatting tags. URLs beginning with http:// or https:// are the only text recognized as clickable links; other body text remains plain text.

Pick posts and join discussions

Pick a post

Sign in and choose Pick on a post to mark it. Choose it again to unpick it. Use the Picks navigation filter to show posts you have picked.

Read and add comments

- Sign in and choose Toggle Comments on a post to show or hide its comment panel.
- Comments are listed newest first. If comments are enabled for the post, enter a comment (up to 300 characters) and choose Add Comment.
- You can edit or delete your own comments using the controls beside them. Comment controls are available only to the comment author.
- If a post owner has disabled comments, the comment form is not shown. Each comment is plain text; `http://` and `https://` URLs appear as clickable links opening in a new tab.

COMMENT DISPLAY

The application shows comment panels to signed-in members. If you do not see comments or a comment form, sign in and check whether comments are enabled on that post.

Manage your account

Choose Account in the top bar while signed in. The page shows your username, account creation date and last login, followed by settings forms.

Change your password

Enter your current password, a new password (8-25 characters) and confirmation. Use the strength indicators as guidance, then choose Change Password. If the current password is incorrect or confirmation does not match, correct the message and resubmit.

Update security question or location

- Edit the security question and enter a new answer, then choose Save Security Details. Your answer is not displayed and is stored securely. Keep it memorable; it is needed for password recovery.
- Choose a new Default Location and choose Save. This location is used for your posts by default and for the distance filter.

Delete your account

The account page includes a self-delete control. It permanently deletes your account, your posts, comments on those posts, and your comments on other posts. The browser asks you to confirm; there is no recovery. Use this only if you are certain.

BEFORE DELETING

Save anything you need first. Account deletion is permanent and also removes your contributed posts and comments.

Quick reference and practical tips

Limits at a glance

- Username: 3-25 characters.
- Password: 8-25 characters; password recovery also enforces character-type and strength requirements.
- Post title: 6-50 characters. Post body: 1-1000 characters.
- Comment: 1-300 characters.
- Clickable URLs: http:// and https:// only; links open in a new tab.

Good account and posting habits

- Never share your password or security answer in a post or comment.
- Choose visibility carefully: Public posts can be read without an account; Members only posts require sign-in.
- Include enough detail and a location so neighbours can understand and find your notice.
- Check the category and expiry before saving. You can edit most post details later, but not the expiry selection.
- Treat links in community posts with care and open them only when you trust their source.

This guide describes behavior visible in the current project routes and templates. Screen layouts may change; use the labels shown in the application if they differ from the illustrative images in this PDF.